

# Chicago Tribune



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No longer old school, in-person matchmaking services are drawing younger, more diverse singles who say they're disheartened by online dating spaces



## 'A CHANCE AT A REAL CONNECTION'

By Darcel Rockett  
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Alicia Williams has had some rough dating experiences. The 29-year-old mom of two dated a guy who claimed he was divorced, even presenting her with papers to prove it. It turns out they were fake because, after Williams searched social media and public records, she discovered he was still married. "He was telling me he wants to build with me. FaceTiming me every night," the Aurora-based aesthetician recalled. "I was completely lied to." Marriage is Williams' goal, but given her less-than-stellar romantic history and dating app

Alicia Williams sits for a portrait on Friday at her Aurora home surrounded by some of her own paintings. Williams is using a matchmaking service for dating and was preparing for a second date with a person Friday night. **JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

fatigue, a client suggested she reach Matchmakers Elite, a service with offices in Oak Brook. "Tired of doing everything" on her own, Williams gave it a try. It's been over two months, and things are going well with one particular man, Williams said. Matchmaking may be old-school, but these days its clientele is skewing younger and more diverse. "When they meet through someone they already trust, like their matchmaker, it helps overcome judgments and allows people of all backgrounds a chance at a real connection," said Anna Rigali, senior matchmaker at Matchmakers Elite.

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## Charges filed in death of CFD firefighter

Police accuse man of murder, arson in Rogers Park blaze

By Caroline Kubzansky  
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

An Avondale man will face murder charges in connection to the Rogers Park fire earlier this week that led to the death of Chicago firefighter Michael Altman. Sheaves Slate, 27, was charged with separate counts of murder, aggravated

arson and residential arson, the Chicago police announced Friday afternoon. Slate was arrested Wednesday afternoon in the Uptown neighborhood and was being held on a warrant unrelated to the fire, according to police. An internal bulletin distributed in the Chicago Police Department identified the man as a person of interest in connection with the fire. Public records show he has a short



Altman

history of prior arrests, including one earlier this year for alleged possession of methamphetamine. In a statement, police Superintendent Larry Snelling offered his condolences to Altman's family and called him a hero, while also thanking first responders who came to the scene. "Although we are proud of the tremendous work done to hold this

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## Architect eyes Soldier Field dome, but Bears still focused elsewhere

By Robert McCoppin  
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

If the Chicago Bears want an enclosed stadium, no need to cross state or city lines, one local architect is suggesting. Why not create one where the team already plays. Edward Peck has come up with a proposal to build a translucent roof on top of Soldier Field, in an effort to keep the team in Chicago. The proposal expands capacity with new suites and fan amenities "to challenge the assumption that Soldier Field is no longer viable," Edward Peck, the managing director of Edward Peck Design, told

the Tribune. Peck was engaged to create the concept by a Bears fan who asked to remain anonymous. But the proposal has no connection to the team, the city, or the Park District, which owns the stadium. Most importantly, there is no identified way to pay for it. As Indiana and Illinois lawmakers spar over where the Bears should build a new stadium, even Gov. JB Pritzker has acknowledged that the team's next home is unlikely to rise within Chicago's city limits. "I think now there's a common understanding by most of the (Illinois) General

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CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

## Cloudy Chicagohenge

Shannon Guest, right, and Proloy Nandi, center, were among a large group of photographers hoping to capture the setting sun on the vernal equinox, dubbed Chicagohenge, on Randolph Street in Chicago on Friday. Significant cloud cover blocked the sun and prevented photographers from capturing the iconic image.

### CTA sues feds for \$2B

The CTA filed a lawsuit against the Trump administration Friday over \$2 billion in frozen federal grant money for the agency's long-awaited Red Line Extension project. **Business**

### Dancing on big stage



Landing in Champaign has given Andrej Stojaković his first real title chase, which continues for Illinois against VCU on Saturday. **Sports**

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